

SENATE RESOLUTION 436

By Harshbarger

A RESOLUTION to honor the life and legacy of Fred Walton of Kingsport.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Fred Walton of Kingsport; and

WHEREAS, a legendary, celebrated head coach of the Dobyns-Bennett High School football team and the first school alumnus to serve in that capacity, Fred Walton inspired countless athletes and brought great pride to his community; and

WHEREAS, a star athlete during his playing days at Dobyns-Bennett High School, Fred Walton earned All-American honors at quarterback for Lees-McRae Junior College before going on to earn his master's degree from East Tennessee State University; and

WHEREAS, Fred Walton began his coaching career in Wise, Virginia, before being promoted to head coach at Dobyns-Bennett High School in 1972; over the next ten years, his teams never endured a losing season, and he became the winningest football coach in school history at the time; and

WHEREAS, Coach Walton was named conference coach of the year five times and his team won at least a share of four conference titles (1974, 1976, 1977, and 1978), making the TSSAA playoffs in 1974, 1976, and 1978, in the era when only the top seed from each conference qualified, and reaching the state semifinals in 1976; and

WHEREAS, after his coaching career, Coach Walton served as the color commentator for the Dobyns-Bennett football radio broadcasts for twenty-six years, staying close to the program; and

WHEREAS, a mentor to many both on and off the gridiron, he served in multiple leadership roles for Kingsport City Schools during his career as an educator, including tenures

at Washington Elementary School, John Sevier Middle School, and later Dobyys-Bennett as the vocational director; and

WHEREAS, an active part of the Kingsport community, Coach Walton was a charter member of the Kingsport Boys Club Hall of Fame, a former president of the Dobyys-Bennett Alumni Association, a member of the Dobyys-Bennett Alumni Hall of Fame, and a charter member of The Crossings Golf Club; he spent two decades as a member of First Kingsport Credit Union Board of Directors, including eighteen years as president; and

WHEREAS, he was also deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Fred Walton leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this inspirational leader and iconic coach; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor the memory of Fred Walton, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and exceptional career. We express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Coach Walton.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.